CODE:1951 SPRING – 2026

Part I — Multiple Choice Questions

1. Self-esteem is related to: Correct Choice: **(A) Self-worth**
2. Gender role socialization begins mainly during: Correct Choice: **(A) Childhood**
3. Which of the following is a source of sex-typing? Correct Choice: **(B) Family**
4. Which institution is most important in early gender socialization? Correct Choice: **(A) Family**
5. A common cognitive topic in gender studies is: Correct Choice: **(A) Verbal ability**
6. One area often compared between men and women is: Correct Choice: **(A) Problem solving**
7. What theory does Hall use to explain non-verbal gender differences as conformity to societal gender-role expectations? Correct Choice: **(B) Social**
8. Compared to men, women in interpersonal settings generally maintain personal space zones that are: Correct Choice: **(C) Smaller**
9. A common social behaviour studied in gender psychology is: Correct Choice: **(A) Cooperation**
10. Stereotypes often lead to: Correct Choice: **(A) Prejudice**
11. Gender roles are: Correct Choice: **(A) Expected behaviours**
12. High achievement motivation is primarily characterized by an individual's desire to Correct Choice: **(A) Excel**
13. A person’s belief about success is linked with: Correct Choice: **(A) Self-concept**
14. A poor self-concept may reduce: Correct Choice: **(A) Motivation**
15. Respect in family relationships supports: Correct Choice: **(A) Stability**
16. A major topic in family life education is: Correct Choice: **(A) Marriage**
17. Social change can challenge harmful: Correct Choice: **(A) Practices**
18. A discriminatory tradition may affect: Correct Choice: **(A) Mobility**
19. Awareness campaigns help reduce: Correct Choice: **(A) Abuse**
20. Sexual harassment is a form of: Correct Choice: **(A) Violence**
21. A child identifying with same-sex parents or peers is an example of: Correct Choice: **(A) Identification**
22. Behaviour that society expects from males and females is known as: Correct Choice: **(B) Gender role**
23. Which factor is most directly biological in nature? Correct Choice: **(A) Chromosomes**
24. The ability to use and understand language is called: Correct Choice: **(A) Verbal ability**
25. Memory involves: Correct Choice: **(A) Storing and recalling information**
26. The ability to solve a puzzle is an example of: Correct Choice: **(D) Problem solving**
27. Confidence in one’s abilities is related to: Correct Choice: **(A) Assertiveness**
28. Gender and personality are often studied through social: Correct Choice: **(A) Interaction**
29. A fixed idea that men should be strong is a gender: Correct Choice: **(A) Norm**
30. Gender roles are mainly learned through: Correct Choice: **(A) Socialization**
31. A person's expectation of success is often related to: Correct Choice: **(B) Performance**
32. A positive achievement attitude usually increases: Correct Choice: **(B) Aspirations**
33. Self-image means the picture a person has of his or her: Correct Choice: **(A) Own self**
34. A child develops self-perception through: Correct Choice: **(A) Social interaction**
35. Family life education may reduce: Correct Choice: **(B) Misunderstanding**

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36. Respect among family members helps maintain: Correct Choice: **(A) Harmony**
37. Social customs can influence a person's: Correct Choice: **(A) Behaviour**
38. Social norms are shared expectations about: Correct Choice: **(A) Behaviour**
39. Physical force used to hurt someone is called: Correct Choice: **(A) Physical abuse**
40. Support for victims helps them recover from: Correct Choice: **(D) Abuse**

Part II — Restricted Response Questions

Question 2 Relate memory and problem-solving skills to gender-based cognitive development.

1. Neurodevelopmental Foundations and Early Cognitive Differences

Cognitive development in males and females is shaped by a complex interplay of biological maturation and environmental interactions during early childhood. Research into neurodevelopment indicates subtle differences in hemispheric lateralization and maturation rates between boys and girls. These physiological variations contribute to early divergences in verbal processing speeds and spatial awareness tasks, laying the groundwork for specialized cognitive strengths that evolve throughout formal education.

2. Verbal Memory Advantages and Linguistic Encoding

Empirical studies consistently demonstrate that females often exhibit superior performance in verbal memory tasks, reading comprehension, and linguistic fluency during developmental stages. This advantage is linked to bilateral cortical representation for language processing in female brains. Consequently, girls tend to encode, retain, and retrieve verbal information with greater efficiency, which subsequently influences academic self-efficacy and learning strategies in language-heavy disciplines.

3. Visuospatial Processing and Problem-Solving Strategies

Conversely, psychological evaluations frequently highlight male advantages in specific visuospatial tasks, such as mental rotation and geometric problem-solving. These competencies facilitate distinct cognitive styles when approaching complex puzzles or mathematical problems. Boys often rely on spatial visualization strategies, whereas girls tend to utilize analytical and verbal mediation techniques to arrive at identical problem-solving solutions.

4. Sociocultural Influences on Cognitive Task Performance

Environmental expectations and gender-role socialization significantly moderate cognitive development and task execution. Stereotypes promoted by parents, educators, and media often channel boys toward spatial and technical activities while steering girls toward verbal domains. These external pressures create differential practice effects, reinforcing specific cognitive pathways and shaping overall intellectual self-perceptions from an early age.

5. Educational Implications and Stereotype Threat Mitigation

Understanding the nexus between gender and cognitive skills is crucial for designing equitable educational environments. Educators must recognize that observed cognitive differences are heavily influenced by experiential practice and cultural encouragement rather than fixed biological



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limits. Implementing inclusive curricula that counter stereotype threat ensures that both male and female students develop balanced memory, analytical, and problem-solving capacities.

Question 3 Apply the concept of gender roles to explain expectations placed on boys and girls in society.

1. Conceptual Framework of Gender Roles

Gender roles refer to the socially prescribed patterns of behavior, attitudes, and responsibilities that a given culture considers appropriate for males and females. These roles function as normative guidelines established through historical traditions and institutional practices. From infancy, individuals are categorized and subjected to differential expectations that dictate their interactions, aspirations, and daily behaviors.

2. Societal Expectations Placed on Boys

Society traditionally expects boys to display instrumental traits such as independence, emotional stoicism, competitiveness, and assertiveness. From early childhood, male socialization discourages vulnerability and expressions of fear or sadness, framing toughness as a mandatory marker of masculinity. Boys are frequently steered toward leadership positions, physical risk-taking, and career paths centered on technical mastery and economic provision.

3. Societal Expectations Placed on Girls

In contrast, societal expectations for girls center heavily on expressive traits, including nurturance, empathy, cooperation, and physical attractiveness. Cultural frameworks encourage girls to prioritize interpersonal relationships, domestic responsibilities, and emotional sensitivity. These expectations often manifest in early play patterns, such as nurturing dolls, and subsequently influence occupational choices toward caregiving and service sectors.

4. Agents of Gender Role Socialization

The transmission of these societal expectations occurs through primary and secondary socialization agents, including family, peer groups, educational institutions, and mass media. Parents assign gender-differentiated chores and toys, while teachers often unconsciously reinforce traditional behavioral boundaries in classrooms. Media further solidifies these roles by portraying men and women in highly stereotyped occupational and domestic scenarios.

5. Psychological Impacts and Behavioral Consequences

Rigid adherence to conventional gender roles can impose significant psychological constraints on both genders. Boys may experience anxiety and emotional repression due to the pressure to constantly prove their masculinity, while girls may face restricted self-esteem and lowered career ambitions due to internalized subordination. Recognizing these pressures is vital for fostering flexible, egalitarian personality development.

Question 4 Apply the idea of culture-specific practices to explain how local customs influence gender behaviour.

1. Definition and Role of Culture-Specific Practices



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Culture-specific practices encompass the traditional rituals, norms, unwritten rules, and behavioral codes unique to a specific community or society. These practices act as powerful socialization mechanisms that dictate what constitutes acceptable conduct for men and women. By embedding gender expectations into daily communal life, culture-specific traditions shape psychological identity from generation to generation.

2. Traditional Customs and Behavioral Conditioning

Local customs often enforce distinct behavioral boundaries through community surveillance and customary rewards or punishments. For instance, ceremonies marking coming-of-age frequently emphasize submissiveness and modesty for young women while celebrating autonomy and physical prowess in young men. Such rituals internalize social hierarchies, making gender-differentiated behaviors appear natural and immutable.

3. Division of Labor and Spatial Mobility Norms

Cultural traditions heavily regulate the spatial mobility and economic participation of different genders. In many traditional settings, customs confine women's activities to domestic spheres, limiting their public exposure and independent economic agency. Conversely, cultural expectations mandate that men operate in public domains as primary breadwinners, creating structural disparities in freedom, resource access, and behavioral expression.

4. Psychological Internalization of Cultural Expectations

Through continuous exposure to local customs, individuals psychologically internalize cultural norms as personal values and moral obligations. Women may develop a heightened sense of collective duty and self-sacrifice, whereas men may internalize protective and patriarchal attitudes. This cognitive alignment ensures that members of society police their own and others' behaviors in accordance with local traditions.

5. Social Change and Evolution of Gender Behaviors

While culture-specific practices exert a powerful stabilizing influence, exposure to education, globalization, and urbanization challenges restrictive customs. As communities engage with broader modern perspectives, harmful discriminatory traditions undergo critical evaluation. Consequently, local gender behaviors evolve, demonstrating that cultural practices are dynamic social constructs rather than permanent biological mandates.

Question 5 Classify the major elements of self-concept and determine their importance in behaviour.

1. Multidimensional Nature of Self-Concept

Self-concept represents the totality of an individual's thoughts, perceptions, and beliefs regarding their own personal identity, attributes, and capabilities. Far from being a monolithic construct, it is multidimensional, incorporating physical, social, academic, and emotional dimensions. This structured mental framework allows individuals to organize self-relevant information and navigate complex social environments effectively.

2. Core Components: Self-Image and Ideal Self



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Two primary structural components of self-concept are self-image and the ideal self. Self-image is the descriptive perception of who one currently is, encompassing physical traits, social roles, and personality characteristics. The ideal self represents the aspirational vision of who an individual desires to be. The degree of congruence between these two elements heavily dictates emotional stability and personal satisfaction.

3. Self-Esteem as the Evaluative Dimension

Self-esteem constitutes the evaluative and affective component of the self-concept, reflecting an individual's overall subjective sense of personal worth. It is shaped by perceived successes, failures, and the internalized feedback of significant others. High self-esteem fosters resilience in the face of adversity, whereas low self-esteem correlates with vulnerability to stress, anxiety, and depressive symptoms.

4. Influence of Self-Concept on Motivation and Goal Setting

An individual's self-concept serves as a primary driver of motivation, goal setting, and achievement behavior. People naturally strive to behave in ways that are consistent with their self-perceptions, a phenomenon known as self-consistency. If a student holds an academic self-concept characterized by high competence, they will set ambitious goals, persist through academic challenges, and interpret setbacks as temporary.

5. Behavioral Regulation and Psychological Adjustment

Ultimately, the self-concept acts as an internal regulatory system that governs social conduct, interpersonal relationships, and psychological adjustment. It dictates how individuals react to criticism, select peer groups, and present themselves in public settings. Maintaining a coherent, realistic, and positive self-concept is therefore essential for mental health, social adaptability, and optimal daily functioning.

Part III — Extended Response Questions

Question 6 A teacher argues that sex and gender mean the same thing. Justify or reject this claim with reasoned psychological support and a clear distinction between the two concepts.

1. Rejection of the Equivalence Claim

The claim that sex and gender are synonymous must be firmly rejected from both contemporary psychological and sociological standpoints. Conflating these two terms ignores decades of empirical research demonstrating that biological characteristics operate independently of psychological identity and social roles. Maintaining a clear conceptual distinction is essential for accurate clinical assessment, educational policy, and psychological research into human behavior.

2. Biological Foundations of Sex

Sex refers strictly to the biological and physiological characteristics that define male and female organisms. These include chromosomal configurations (such as XX and XY), hormonal profiles (estrogen, progesterone, and testosterone), internal reproductive structures, and external genitalia. Biological sex is determined at conception and pertains directly to physiological and anatomical attributes rather than psychological states.



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3. Psychosocial Construction of Gender

In sharp contrast, gender is a psychological, cultural, and social construct that refers to the socially learned behaviors, expectations, identities, and roles associated with being male or female in a given culture. Gender encompasses masculinity and femininity as psychological attributes and social statuses. It is acquired through ongoing socialization processes, cultural conditioning, and personal identity formation rather than genetic programming alone.

4. Psychological Differentiation Between Biological and Social Identities

Psychologically, an individual's internal sense of self—known as gender identity—can occasionally diverge from their biological sex, as observed in transgender and non-binary individuals. This empirical reality proves that biological makeup does not unilaterally dictate psychological experience. Psychological frameworks must therefore separate physiological sex from subjective gender identity to understand mental health and self-perception accurately.

5. Developmental Trajectories and Role Acquisition

The developmental pathways of sex and gender operate through entirely different mechanisms. Biological sex matures according to innate genetic and endocrinological timelines. Gender roles and behaviors, however, are acquired through cognitive development, observational learning, parental reinforcement, and peer interaction. Children learn what society expects of their gender long before they fully comprehend physiological reproductive differences.

6. Empirical Evidence from Cross-Cultural and Clinical Studies

Cross-cultural research provides robust evidence against the equivalence of sex and gender. Anthropological and psychological studies show that traits deemed "masculine" or "feminine" vary dramatically across different societies, whereas biological sex markers remain constant. Furthermore, clinical investigations involving individuals with intersex conditions illustrate that gender identity often develops independently of ambiguous biological markers, reinforcing their distinct status.

7. Cognitive and Behavioral Manifestations of Gender Identity

Gender identity heavily influences cognitive processing, self-esteem, and behavioral preferences through schema formation. Children develop gender schemas—mental networks of beliefs about what is appropriate for males and females—which guide their attention, memory, and actions. These cognitive structures operate independently of biological sex, dictating how individuals interpret their social world and evaluate their own personal efficacy.

8. Implications for Mental Health and Interpersonal Dynamics

Failing to distinguish between sex and gender leads to flawed psychological interventions and rigid societal prejudices. Mental health professionals recognize that psychological distress often arises when individuals are pressured to conform to traditional gender expectations that clash with their internal identity or authentic capabilities. A nuanced understanding of both concepts enables therapists to provide affirming, effective care for diverse populations.

9. Conclusion and Academic Consensus on Sex-Gender Divergence



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In conclusion, treating sex and gender as interchangeable terms is scientifically inaccurate and conceptually obsolete. Sex represents the biological substrate, while gender embodies the psychological and sociocultural superstructure of human identity. Acknowledging this vital distinction enriches psychological science, promotes social equity, and fosters a more profound understanding of the complex determinants of human behavior.

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